

Lecture 6: Data Wrangling

Heather Mattie, PhD

September 18, 2025

Recipes of the Day!

Happy Hispanic Heritage Month!

Beef Empanadas



Announcements

- There will be lab this week
- Homework #1 deadline pushed to Friday, September 26
- Grab a duckie!



Data Wrangling

Data Wrangling Roadmap

1. `dplyr` functions
2. Importing data
3. Reshaping data
4. Combining data frames
5. Parsing dates and times

Data Wrangling

`dplyr` functions

Heather Mattie, PhD

The Data Science Pipeline



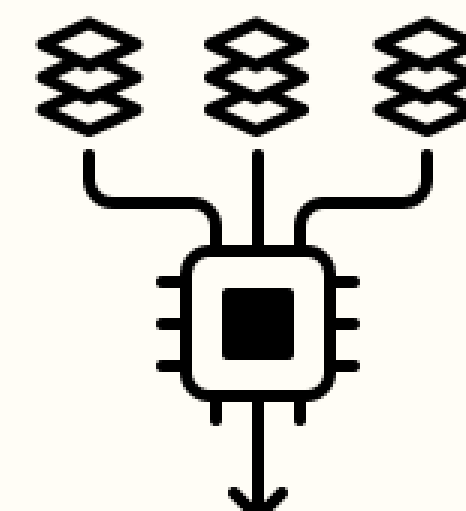
**Collecting
and
importing
(loading)
the data**



**Processing
(cleaning,
wrangling)
the data**



Visualizing
and
summarizing
the data



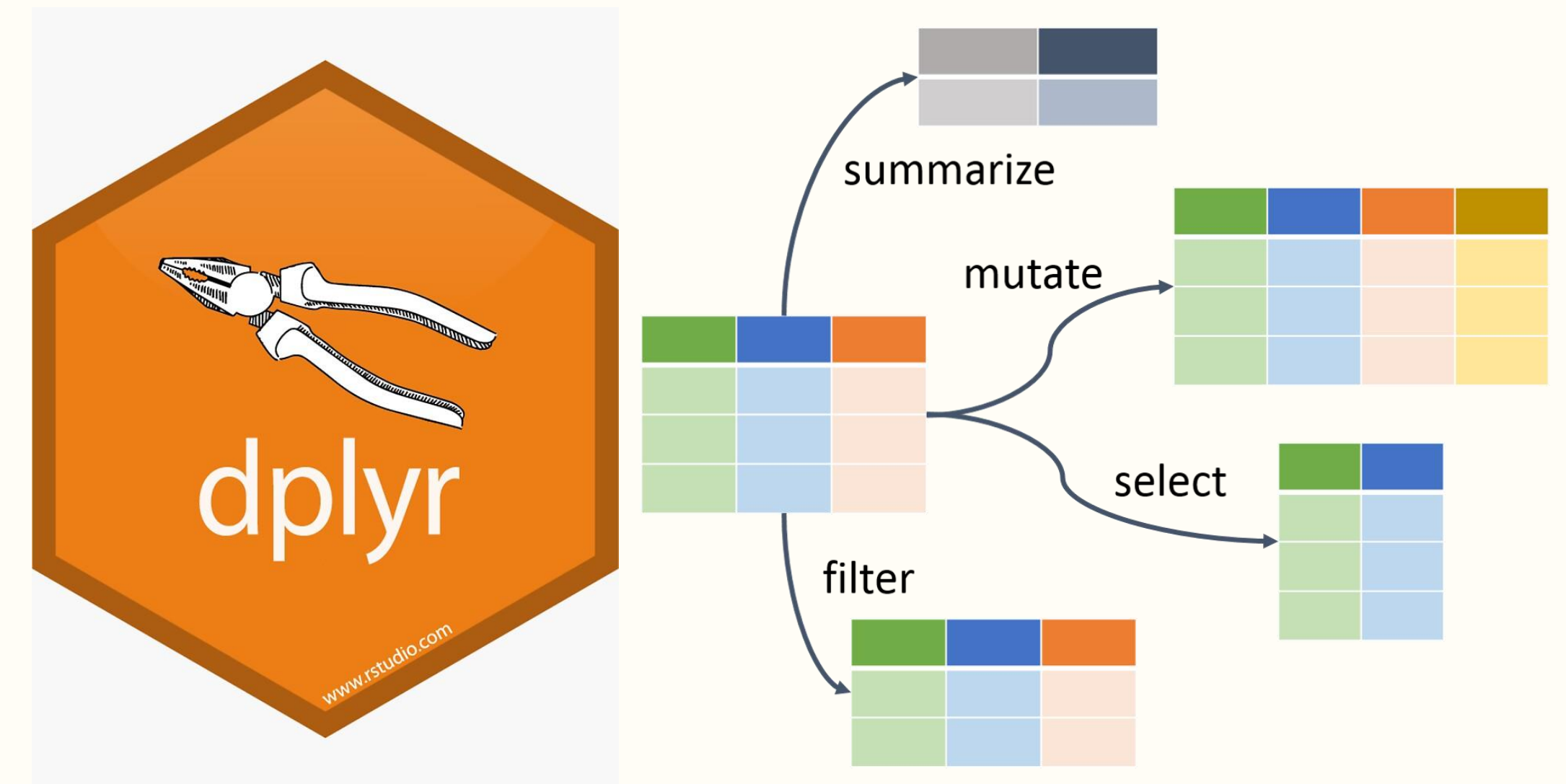
Building
models
(statistical
and ML)



Interpretation
and
communication
of results

The **dplyr** package

dplyr is an R package containing functions that are useful for manipulating data frames in an intuitive, user-friendly way



The pipe

The pipe operator, `%>%`, is a powerful tool for chaining multiple operations (coding steps) together

- Code is more readable
- Code is more efficient
- Takes the output of one function and uses it as the input of the next function or expression



mutate

The **mutate** function creates new columns

- Can be functions of existing variables
- Can modify and delete existing columns

```
library(dslabs)
data(murders)
head(murders)
```

```
##      state abb region population total
## 1  Alabama  AL  South   4779736    135
## 2  Alaska   AK   West    710231     19
## 3  Arizona  AZ   West   6392017    232
## 4  Arkansas AR   South   2915918     93
## 5 California CA   West  37253956   1257
## 6  Colorado CO   West   5029196     65
```

```
library(dplyr)
murders <- murders %>% mutate(murder_rate = total / population * 100000)
head(murders)
```

```
##      state abb region population total murder_rate
## 1  Alabama  AL  South   4779736    135    2.824424
## 2  Alaska   AK   West    710231     19    2.675186
## 3  Arizona  AZ   West   6392017    232    3.629527
## 4  Arkansas AR   South   2915918     93    3.189390
## 5 California CA   West  37253956   1257    3.374138
## 6  Colorado CO   West   5029196     65    1.292453
```

filter

The **filter** function is used to subset a data frame

- Retains rows that satisfy all conditions
- When a condition results in NA, the row will be dropped

```
murders %>% filter(murder_rate <= 0.71)
```

##	state	abb	region	population	total	murder_rate
## 1	Hawaii	HI	West	1360301	7	0.5145920
## 2	Iowa	IA	North Central	3046355	21	0.6893484
## 3	New Hampshire	NH	Northeast	1316470	5	0.3798036
## 4	North Dakota	ND	North Central	672591	4	0.5947151
## 5	Vermont	VT	Northeast	625741	2	0.3196211

select

The **select** function is used to select variables (columns) based on their name

- Can also be used to rename columns

```
murders %>% select(state, region, murder_rate) %>%  
filter(murder_rate <= 0.71)
```

##	state	region	murder_rate
## 1	Hawaii	West	0.5145920
## 2	Iowa	North Central	0.6893484
## 3	New Hampshire	Northeast	0.3798036
## 4	North Dakota	North Central	0.5947151
## 5	Vermont	Northeast	0.3196211

summarize

The **summarize** function is used to create summary statistics of data

- Takes a data frame and outputs a new data frame with a single row containing specified summary calculations
- Returns a new data frame with one row for each group if the original data frame has been grouped by columns and/or rows

```
us_murder_rate <- murders %>%  
  summarize(murder_rate = sum(total) / sum(population) * 100000)  
  
us_murder_rate
```

```
##      murder_rate  
## 1      3.034555
```

```
us_murder_rate <- murders %>%  
  summarize( murder_rate = sum(total) / sum(population) * 100000) %>%  
  .$murder_rate  
  
us_murder_rate
```

```
## [1] 3.034555
```

group_by

The **group_by** function takes a data frame and converts it into a grouped data frame where operations are performed by group

- **ungroup()** removes the grouping

```
murders %>%  
  group_by(region) %>%  
  summarize(median_rate = median(murder_rate))
```

```
## # A tibble: 4 × 2  
##   region      median_rate  
##   <fct>         <dbl>  
## 1 Northeast      1.80  
## 2 South          3.40  
## 3 North Central  1.97  
## 4 West           1.29
```


arrange

The **arrange** function orders the rows of a data frame by the values of selected columns

- The default is ascending order

```
murders %>%  
  arrange(murder_rate) %>%  
  head()
```

##	state	abb	region	population	total	murder_rate
## 1	Vermont	VT	Northeast	625741	2	0.3196211
## 2	New Hampshire	NH	Northeast	1316470	5	0.3798036
## 3	Hawaii	HI	West	1360301	7	0.5145920
## 4	North Dakota	ND	North Central	672591	4	0.5947151
## 5	Iowa	IA	North Central	3046355	21	0.6893484
## 6	Idaho	ID	West	1567582	12	0.7655102

arrange

The **arrange** function orders the rows of a data frame by the values of selected columns

- The default is ascending order
- Can use the **desc()** function to switch to descending order

```
murders %>%  
  arrange(desc(murder_rate)) %>%  
  head()
```

##		state	abb	region	population	total	murder_rate
## 1	District of Columbia	DC		South	601723	99	16.452753
## 2	Louisiana	LA		South	4533372	351	7.742581
## 3	Missouri	MO	North Central		5988927	321	5.359892
## 4	Maryland	MD		South	5773552	293	5.074866
## 5	South Carolina	SC		South	4625364	207	4.475323
## 6	Delaware	DE		South	897934	38	4.231937

slice

The **slice** set of functions index rows by their integer locations

- Used to select, remove, and duplicate rows

```
murders %>% slice(1:10)
```

##	state	abb	region	population	total	murder_rate
## 1	Alabama	AL	South	4779736	135	2.824424
## 2	Alaska	AK	West	710231	19	2.675186
## 3	Arizona	AZ	West	6392017	232	3.629527
## 4	Arkansas	AR	South	2915918	93	3.189390
## 5	California	CA	West	37253956	1257	3.374138
## 6	Colorado	CO	West	5029196	65	1.292453
## 7	Connecticut	CT	Northeast	3574097	97	2.713972
## 8	Delaware	DE	South	897934	38	4.231937
## 9	District of Columbia	DC	South	601723	99	16.452753
## 10	Florida	FL	South	19687653	669	3.398069

slice

The **slice** set of functions index rows by their integer locations

- Used to select, remove, and duplicate rows

```
murders %>% slice(-c(3:5, 9:51))
```

##		state	abb	region	population	total	murder_rate
## 1		Alabama	AL	South	4779736	135	2.824424
## 2		Alaska	AK	West	710231	19	2.675186
## 3		Colorado	CO	West	5029196	65	1.292453
## 4		Connecticut	CT	Northeast	3574097	97	2.713972
## 5		Delaware	DE	South	897934	38	4.231937

slice

The **slice** set of functions index rows by their integer locations

- Used to select, remove, and duplicate rows

```
murders %>% slice_head(n = 3)
```

```
##      state abb region population total murder_rate
## 1 Alabama  AL  South    4779736    135    2.824424
## 2  Alaska  AK   West     710231     19    2.675186
## 3 Arizona  AZ   West    6392017    232    3.629527
```

```
murders %>% slice_tail(n = 5)
```

```
##      state abb      region population total murder_rate
## 1  Virginia  VA      South    8001024    250    3.1246001
## 2 Washington  WA      West    6724540     93    1.3829942
## 3 West Virginia WV      South    1852994     27    1.4571013
## 4 Wisconsin  WI North Central    5686986     97    1.7056487
## 5  Wyoming   WY      West     563626      5    0.8871131
```

Summary

- The **dplyr** package contains functions that are useful in wrangling data in a data frame
- The pipe operator is a tool to chain multiple operations together in an efficient way
- Throughout this course we will be using the **mutate**, **filter**, **select**, **summarize**, **group_by**, **arrange**, and **slice** functions to manipulate data frames

Data Wrangling

Importing data

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Tidy data

Tidy data is a standardized way to structure datasets so they are easy to understand and analyze

- Each observation is a row
- Each variable is a column
- The **tidyverse** package can be used for data wrangling



Gapminder example

Tidy data format

```
library(tidyverse)
library(dslabs)
data("gapminder")
head(gapminder)
```

```
##           country year infant_mortality life_expectancy fertility
## 1      Albania 1960      115.40           62.87           6.19
## 2      Algeria 1960      148.20           47.50           7.65
## 3       Angola 1960      208.00           35.98           7.32
## 4 Antigua and Barbuda 1960      NA           62.97           4.43
## 5      Argentina 1960      59.87           65.39           3.11
## 6      Armenia 1960      NA           66.86           4.55
##  population      gdp continent      region
## 1    1636054      NA    Europe Southern Europe
## 2    11124892 13828152297    Africa Northern Africa
## 3     5270844      NA    Africa  Middle Africa
## 4      54681      NA  Americas      Caribbean
## 5    20619075 108322326649  Americas    South America
## 6     1867396      NA     Asia    Western Asia
```

Gapminder example

Raw data

```
library(tidyverse)
library(dslabs)
filename <- "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rafalab/dslabs/master/inst/extdata/fertility-two-countries-example.csv"
wide_data <- read_csv(filename)
head(wide_data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 57
##   country `1960` `1961` `1962` `1963` `1964` `1965` `1966` `1967` `1968` `1969`
##   <chr>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 Germany  2.41  2.44  2.47  2.49  2.49  2.48  2.44  2.37  2.28  2.17
## 2 South K... 6.16  5.99  5.79  5.57  5.36  5.16  4.99  4.85  4.73  4.62
## # i 46 more variables: `1970` <dbl>, `1971` <dbl>, `1972` <dbl>, `1973` <dbl>,
## #   `1974` <dbl>, `1975` <dbl>, `1976` <dbl>, `1977` <dbl>, `1978` <dbl>,
## #   `1979` <dbl>, `1980` <dbl>, `1981` <dbl>, `1982` <dbl>, `1983` <dbl>,
## #   `1984` <dbl>, `1985` <dbl>, `1986` <dbl>, `1987` <dbl>, `1988` <dbl>,
## #   `1989` <dbl>, `1990` <dbl>, `1991` <dbl>, `1992` <dbl>, `1993` <dbl>,
## #   `1994` <dbl>, `1995` <dbl>, `1996` <dbl>, `1997` <dbl>, `1998` <dbl>,
## #   `1999` <dbl>, `2000` <dbl>, `2001` <dbl>, `2002` <dbl>, `2003` <dbl>, ...
```

Working directory

The **working directory** is where R will save or look for files by default

- When importing data from a file on a computer, R will search the files in the working directory first

```
getwd()
```

```
## [1] "/Users/hem122/Desktop"
```


Paths

If the file is not in the working directory, a **path** to the file is required to import it

- The path indicates the location (folder) of the file on a computer or on a website

```
path <- system.file("extdata", package = "dslabs")  
path
```

```
## [1] "/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/  
library/dslabs/extdata"
```

```
filename <- "murders.csv"  
fullpath <- file.path(path, filename)  
fullpath
```

```
## [1] "/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/  
library/dslabs/extdata/murders.csv"
```


readr

The **readr** package includes functions for reading data stored in a spreadsheet file into R

Function	Format	Typical suffix
read_table	white space separated values	txt
read_csv	comma separated values	csv
read_csv2	semicolon separated values	csv
read_tsv	tab delimited separated values	tsv
read_delim	general text file format, must define delimiter	txt

readxl

The **readxl** package provides functions for reading in Microsoft Excel formats

Function	Format	Typical suffix
read_excel	auto detect the format	xls, xlsx
read_xls	original format	xls
read_xlsx	new format	xlsx

Raw Gapminder data

```
library(tidyverse)
library(dslabs)
filename <- "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rafalab/dslabs/master/inst/extdata/fertility-two-countries-example.csv"
wide_data <- read_csv(filename)
head(wide_data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 57
##   country `1960` `1961` `1962` `1963` `1964` `1965` `1966` `1967` `1968` `1969`
##   <chr>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 Germany  2.41  2.44  2.47  2.49  2.49  2.48  2.44  2.37  2.28  2.17
## 2 South K... 6.16  5.99  5.79  5.57  5.36  5.16  4.99  4.85  4.73  4.62
## # i 46 more variables: `1970` <dbl>, `1971` <dbl>, `1972` <dbl>, `1973` <dbl>,
## #   `1974` <dbl>, `1975` <dbl>, `1976` <dbl>, `1977` <dbl>, `1978` <dbl>,
## #   `1979` <dbl>, `1980` <dbl>, `1981` <dbl>, `1982` <dbl>, `1983` <dbl>,
## #   `1984` <dbl>, `1985` <dbl>, `1986` <dbl>, `1987` <dbl>, `1988` <dbl>,
## #   `1989` <dbl>, `1990` <dbl>, `1991` <dbl>, `1992` <dbl>, `1993` <dbl>,
## #   `1994` <dbl>, `1995` <dbl>, `1996` <dbl>, `1997` <dbl>, `1998` <dbl>,
## #   `1999` <dbl>, `2000` <dbl>, `2001` <dbl>, `2002` <dbl>, `2003` <dbl>, ...
```


Summary

- Data wrangling is the process of transforming raw data into a useable format called tidy data
- Tidy data format requires each variable to be a column and each observation a row
- The **readr** and **readxl** packages contain functions to read in spreadsheets of data

Data Wrangling

Reshaping data

Heather Mattie, PhD

Raw Gapminder data

```
library(tidyverse)
library(dslabs)
filename <- "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rafalab/dslabs/master/inst/extdata/fertility-two-countries-example.csv"
wide_data <- read_csv(filename)
head(wide_data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 57
##   country `1960` `1961` `1962` `1963` `1964` `1965` `1966` `1967` `1968` `1969`
##   <chr>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 Germany  2.41  2.44  2.47  2.49  2.49  2.48  2.44  2.37  2.28  2.17
## 2 South K... 6.16  5.99  5.79  5.57  5.36  5.16  4.99  4.85  4.73  4.62
## # i 46 more variables: `1970` <dbl>, `1971` <dbl>, `1972` <dbl>, `1973` <dbl>,
## #   `1974` <dbl>, `1975` <dbl>, `1976` <dbl>, `1977` <dbl>, `1978` <dbl>,
## #   `1979` <dbl>, `1980` <dbl>, `1981` <dbl>, `1982` <dbl>, `1983` <dbl>,
## #   `1984` <dbl>, `1985` <dbl>, `1986` <dbl>, `1987` <dbl>, `1988` <dbl>,
## #   `1989` <dbl>, `1990` <dbl>, `1991` <dbl>, `1992` <dbl>, `1993` <dbl>,
## #   `1994` <dbl>, `1995` <dbl>, `1996` <dbl>, `1997` <dbl>, `1998` <dbl>,
## #   `1999` <dbl>, `2000` <dbl>, `2001` <dbl>, `2002` <dbl>, `2003` <dbl>, ...
```

pivot_longer

The **pivot_longer** function converts wide data into tidy data

- The first argument is which columns to collapse
- The second argument is the name of the column that will store the values of the collapsed columns
- The third argument is the name of the column that will store the values in the original data frame

```
new_tidy_data <- wide_data %>%  
  pivot_longer(`1960`:`2015`, names_to = "year", values_to = "fertility")  
head(new_tidy_data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 6 × 3  
##   country year  fertility  
##   <chr>   <chr>    <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960      2.41  
## 2 Germany 1961      2.44  
## 3 Germany 1962      2.47  
## 4 Germany 1963      2.49  
## 5 Germany 1964      2.49  
## 6 Germany 1965      2.48
```


pivot_longer

The **pivot_longer** function converts wide data into tidy data

- The first argument is which columns to collapse
- The second argument is the name of the column that will store the values of the collapsed columns
- The third argument is the name of the column that will store the values in the original data frame

```
new_tidy_data <- wide_data %>%  
  pivot_longer(-country, names_to = "year", values_to = "fertility")  
head(new_tidy_data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 6 × 3  
##   country year  fertility  
##   <chr>   <chr>    <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960      2.41  
## 2 Germany 1961      2.44  
## 3 Germany 1962      2.47  
## 4 Germany 1963      2.49  
## 5 Germany 1964      2.49  
## 6 Germany 1965      2.48
```


pivot_longer

The **pivot_longer** function converts wide data into tidy data

- The first argument is which columns to collapse
- The second argument is the name of the column that will store the values of the collapsed columns
- The third argument is the name of the column that will store the values in the original data frame

```
new_tidy_data <- wide_data %>%  
  pivot_longer(-country, names_to = "year", values_to = "fertility") %>%  
  mutate(year = as.integer(year))  
head(new_tidy_data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 6 × 3  
##   country year fertility  
##   <chr>   <int>     <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960      2.41  
## 2 Germany 1961      2.44  
## 3 Germany 1962      2.47  
## 4 Germany 1963      2.49  
## 5 Germany 1964      2.49  
## 6 Germany 1965      2.48
```

pivot_wider

The **pivot_wider** function converts tidy data into wide data

- The first argument, **names_to**, indicates which variable will be used as column names
- The second argument, **values_from**, specifies which variable to use to fill in the cells

```
new_wide_data <- new_tidy_data %>%  
  pivot_wider(names_from = year, values_from = fertility)  
  
new_wide_data %>% select(country, `1960`:`1967`)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 9  
##   country    `1960` `1961` `1962` `1963` `1964` `1965` `1966` `1967`  
##   <chr>      <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>  
## 1 Germany    2.41  2.44  2.47  2.49  2.49  2.48  2.44  2.37  
## 2 South Korea 6.16  5.99  5.79  5.57  5.36  5.16  4.99  4.85
```

Raw Gapminder data #2

```
path      <- system.file("extdata", package = "dslabs")
filename <- file.path(path, "life-expectancy-and-fertility-two-countries-example.csv")

raw_data <- read_csv(filename)
select(raw_data, 1:5)
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 5
##   country      `1960_fertility` `1960_life_expectancy` `1961_fertility`
##   <chr>          <dbl>          <dbl>          <dbl>
## 1 Germany         2.41          69.3          2.44
## 2 South Korea      6.16          53.0          5.99
## # i 1 more variable: `1961_life_expectancy` <dbl>
```


Raw Gapminder data #2

```
data <- raw_data %>% pivot_longer(-country)
head(data)
```

```
## # A tibble: 6 × 3
##   country name      value
##   <chr>   <chr>      <dbl>
## 1 Germany 1960_fertility    2.41
## 2 Germany 1960_life_expectancy 69.3
## 3 Germany 1961_fertility    2.44
## 4 Germany 1961_life_expectancy 69.8
## 5 Germany 1962_fertility    2.47
## 6 Germany 1962_life_expectancy 70.0
```


separate

The **separate** function is used to split a single column into multiple columns

- The default character to split on is an underscore **_**

```
data %>% separate(name, c("year", "variable_name"), "_")
```

```
## # A tibble: 224 × 4
##   country year variable_name value
##   <chr>   <chr> <chr>         <dbl>
## 1 Germany 1960 fertility     2.41
## 2 Germany 1960 life         69.3
## 3 Germany 1961 fertility     2.44
## 4 Germany 1961 life         69.8
## 5 Germany 1962 fertility     2.47
## 6 Germany 1962 life         70.0
## 7 Germany 1963 fertility     2.49
## 8 Germany 1963 life         70.1
## 9 Germany 1964 fertility     2.49
## 10 Germany 1964 life         70.7
## # i 214 more rows
```

separate

The **separate** function is used to split a single column into multiple columns

- The default character to split on is an underscore **_**

```
data %>% separate(name, c("year", "variable_name"))
```

```
## # A tibble: 224 × 4
##   country year variable_name value
##   <chr>   <chr> <chr>         <dbl>
## 1 Germany 1960 fertility     2.41
## 2 Germany 1960 life         69.3
## 3 Germany 1961 fertility     2.44
## 4 Germany 1961 life         69.8
## 5 Germany 1962 fertility     2.47
## 6 Germany 1962 life         70.0
## 7 Germany 1963 fertility     2.49
## 8 Germany 1963 life         70.1
## 9 Germany 1964 fertility     2.49
## 10 Germany 1964 life         70.7
## # i 214 more rows
```

separate

The **separate** function is used to split a single column into multiple columns

- The default character to split on is an underscore **_**
- Adding **extra = "merge"** as an argument will ignore future instances of the splitting character

```
data %>% separate(name, c("year", "name"), extra = "merge")
```

```
## # A tibble: 224 × 4
##   country year  name      value
##   <chr>   <chr> <chr>    <dbl>
## 1 Germany 1960  fertility  2.41
## 2 Germany 1960  life_expectancy 69.3
## 3 Germany 1961  fertility  2.44
## 4 Germany 1961  life_expectancy 69.8
## 5 Germany 1962  fertility  2.47
## 6 Germany 1962  life_expectancy 70.0
## 7 Germany 1963  fertility  2.49
## 8 Germany 1963  life_expectancy 70.1
## 9 Germany 1964  fertility  2.49
## 10 Germany 1964  life_expectancy 70.7
## # i 214 more rows
```


separate

The **separate** function is used to split a single column into multiple columns

- The default character to split on is an underscore **_**
- Adding **extra = "merge"** as an argument will ignore future instances of the splitting character

```
data %>%  
  separate(name, c("year", "name"), extra = "merge") %>%  
  pivot_wider()
```

```
## # A tibble: 112 × 4  
##   country year  fertility life_expectancy  
##   <chr>   <chr>      <dbl>         <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960      2.41          69.3  
## 2 Germany 1961      2.44          69.8  
## 3 Germany 1962      2.47          70.0  
## 4 Germany 1963      2.49          70.1  
## 5 Germany 1964      2.49          70.7  
## 6 Germany 1965      2.48          70.6  
## 7 Germany 1966      2.44          70.8  
## 8 Germany 1967      2.37          71.0  
## 9 Germany 1968      2.28          70.6  
## 10 Germany 1969      2.17          70.5  
## # i 102 more rows
```


unite

The **unite** function is used to combine two columns into one

```
var_names <- c("year", "first_variable_name", "second_variable_name")
data %>% separate(name, var_names, fill = "right")
```

```
## # A tibble: 224 × 5
##   country year first_variable_name second_variable_name value
##   <chr>   <chr> <chr>                        <chr>                <dbl>
## 1 Germany 1960 fertility                <NA>                2.41
## 2 Germany 1960 life                expectancy          69.3
## 3 Germany 1961 fertility                <NA>                2.44
## 4 Germany 1961 life                expectancy          69.8
## 5 Germany 1962 fertility                <NA>                2.47
## 6 Germany 1962 life                expectancy          70.0
## 7 Germany 1963 fertility                <NA>                2.49
## 8 Germany 1963 life                expectancy          70.1
## 9 Germany 1964 fertility                <NA>                2.49
## 10 Germany 1964 life                expectancy          70.7
## # i 214 more rows
```

unite

The **unite** function is used to combine two columns into one

- The default character to unite on is an underscore **_**

```
data %>% separate(name, var_names, fill = "right") %>%  
  unite(name, first_variable_name, second_variable_name)
```

```
## # A tibble: 224 x 4  
##   country year  name      value  
##   <chr>   <chr> <chr>    <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960  fertility_NA  2.41  
## 2 Germany 1960  life_expectancy 69.3  
## 3 Germany 1961  fertility_NA  2.44  
## 4 Germany 1961  life_expectancy 69.8  
## 5 Germany 1962  fertility_NA  2.47  
## 6 Germany 1962  life_expectancy 70.0  
## 7 Germany 1963  fertility_NA  2.49  
## 8 Germany 1963  life_expectancy 70.1  
## 9 Germany 1964  fertility_NA  2.49  
## 10 Germany 1964  life_expectancy 70.7  
## # i 214 more rows
```

unite

The **unite** function is used to combine two columns into one

- The default character to unite on is an underscore **_**

```
data %>% separate(name, var_names, fill = "right") %>%  
  unite(name, first_variable_name, second_variable_name) %>%  
  pivot_wider()
```

```
## # A tibble: 112 × 4  
##   country year  fertility_NA life_expectancy  
##   <chr>   <chr>         <dbl>         <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960          2.41          69.3  
## 2 Germany 1961          2.44          69.8  
## 3 Germany 1962          2.47          70.0  
## 4 Germany 1963          2.49          70.1  
## 5 Germany 1964          2.49          70.7  
## 6 Germany 1965          2.48          70.6  
## 7 Germany 1966          2.44          70.8  
## 8 Germany 1967          2.37          71.0  
## 9 Germany 1968          2.28          70.6  
## 10 Germany 1969          2.17          70.5  
## # i 102 more rows
```


unite

The **unite** function is used to combine two columns into one

- The default character to unite on is an underscore **_**

```
data %>% separate(name, var_names, fill = "right") %>%  
  unite(name, first_variable_name, second_variable_name) %>%  
  pivot_wider() %>%  
  rename(fertility = fertility_NA)
```

```
## # A tibble: 112 × 4  
##   country year  fertility life_expectancy  
##   <chr>   <chr>      <dbl>         <dbl>  
## 1 Germany 1960      2.41          69.3  
## 2 Germany 1961      2.44          69.8  
## 3 Germany 1962      2.47          70.0  
## 4 Germany 1963      2.49          70.1  
## 5 Germany 1964      2.49          70.7  
## 6 Germany 1965      2.48          70.6  
## 7 Germany 1966      2.44          70.8  
## 8 Germany 1967      2.37          71.0  
## 9 Germany 1968      2.28          70.6  
## 10 Germany 1969      2.17          70.5  
## # i 102 more rows
```


Summary

- The `pivot_longer` function converts wide data into tidy data
- The `pivot_wider` function converts tidy data into long data
- The `separate` function splits a single column into multiple columns
- The `unite` function combines two columns into a single column